

models that are in practice today. A new model is born practically every few weeks as businesses learn what works best for them within their particular sector. Some of the models that are at the cusp of making it big in India are:

Personalization: A variety of sites are coming up that enable you to personalize anything that you may decide to purchase online. You can custom-build your computer with DELL or Apple, get a t-shirt that has your design on it or get custom pieces of furniture and interior décor. There are also sites that enable users to convert their memories into something meaningful like a personalized calendar, a coffee table book with your travel memoirs, or even a book of your family's best recipes.



Flash Sell or Invite Only: A concept where a product or service goes on sale online at a specific time for a limited period and sometimes even in limited series. The majority of flash concepts are still limited to fashion such as 99labels in India or Vente-Privée in France, but can be easily expanded across sectors.

Shopping through Games: While this model has not picked up steam in India yet, Fantasy Shopper was first launched in the UK in October 2011. A social shopping game, Fantasy Shoppers gives users fantasy money to browse, style and purchase from over 300 real stores. Players unlock major shopping destinations, complete challenges to create a 'Fashionista' reputation all the while earning real discount codes and vouchers for participating brands.

As can be seen, there are myriad models that can be adopted by e-commerce ventures. In India today, the vast majority of these continue to be within the megamall and marketplace space and there is some level of catching up to do within the other more unique models.